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Q: How much has changed from the past and how much from your earlier experiences can perhaps be adapted today?

A: Today, we talk about global capital markets and capitalism being dead. No, [they are] not dead. We need each other more than ever before. It has just got a different way of rewiring itself.

I was fortunate enough to spend some time going through various crises. Those include 9/11 or the global financial crisis or the dotcom story. At times, we reflect too much on what has served us well in the past but that may not be fit for what lies ahead. Our definition of key metrics like GDP is a great example of this. But in today's environment with zero interest rates or even negative interest rates, a fully employed labour force in some countries or a potential recession [in others], a lot of economic philosophy may be relevant but not absolute.

There is also a need for leadership to be more engaging, and listening to ensure it can be much more responsive with speed and urgency. That's going to be a challenge and I think, for the next decade, the question will be on how we move with speed and certainty to take advantage of the opportunities and at the same time, mitigate or minimise the downside risks.

Q: We live in uncertainty coupled with disruption. If those can possibly be dealt with, how does one contend with inflation?

“The difference between China and India is that in the case of China, you had uniformity relevant to how government and business interacted. In India, you’ve got the federal-like level and the state-like level and not as much alignment as necessary to drive speed, certainty and scalability”

A: The reality is that certain parts of the world have had to deal with inflation for the past two decades and India is one of them. Some of the emerging economies in South America have also faced it.

But let's go back to the fundamental principles. You can control what you can control, but not get disrupted and distracted by what you can't control. Your job is to pull the levers of change. And then when things change around you or move fast, you need to adjust. And that's the leadership challenge now. So, for corporates, the traditional budgeting for the next three to five years is less certain now. It's more about the scenarios and figuring out what do I do in x-, y- and z scenarios,